

Participant Information Sheet for Neural Style Transfer Final Project

Title of the research study: Neural Style Transfer: Evaluating Content Preservation and Perceived Emotional Consistency Across Visually Distinct Artistic Styles.

Name:

Email:

Invitation

You are being invited to take part in a research study. Before you decide whether or not to take part, it is important for you to understand why the research is being done and what it will involve. Please take time to read the following information carefully.

What is the purpose of the study?

This survey supports an undergraduate final year project investigating Neural Style Transfer (NST), a computer vision technique that repaints a photograph in the visual style of an artwork. Alongside technical measurements, the project asks how the perceived mood of an image changes once a style is applied, and how recognisable and how convincingly stylised the result appears to a human viewer. Your responses will be used as a small-scale, exploratory human evaluation to complement the project's quantitative results.

Why have I been invited to participate?

You have been invited as an adult volunteer known to the researcher.

Do I have to take part?

No. Taking part is entirely voluntary. If you decide to take part, you will be shown this information and asked to confirm your consent before the survey begins. Deciding not to take part, or stopping partway through, carries no consequence of any kind.

Can I withdraw from the study?

You may close the form at any time before submitting it, and your partial answers will not be recorded. Because responses are collected anonymously and are not linked to any name or contact detail, once you have submitted the form your individual response cannot be identified or removed from the dataset.

What will happen if I take part?

You will be shown a small number of original photographs, followed by AI-stylised versions of them, and asked to answer short multiple choice questions about the mood, recognisability and visual quality of each image. This takes approximately 8 to 10 minutes and is completed in a single sitting via an online Google Form.

What are the possible disadvantages and risks of taking part?

None are anticipated. The task only involves viewing images and answering short questions.

What are the possible benefits of taking part?

Your responses will contribute to a small human-evaluation component of a final year research project on neural style transfer.

Will what I say in this study be kept confidential?

Yes. The survey does not collect your name, email address, or any other identifying information, and your individual responses cannot be traced back to you. Aggregated, anonymous results may be included in the researcher's final year report. Full details of how your data is handled are set out in the Data Protection Privacy Notice below.

What will happen to the results of the research study?

Anonymised, aggregated results will be reported in the researcher's final year dissertation, submitted for assessment as part of the CM3070 module. No individual respondent will be identifiable in the report.

Who is organising the research?

This is an independent undergraduate final year project undertaken as part of the BSc Computer Science degree (CM3070 module), University of London. The study is not externally funded.

What if something goes wrong?

If you have any concerns about your participation or about the study in general, you should first contact the initial researcher listed above. If you feel your complaint has not been satisfactorily handled, you can contact the Chair of the Goldsmiths Research Ethics and Integrity Sub-Committee via Research Services (020 7919 7770, reisc@gold.ac.uk).

Thank you for reading this information sheet and for considering whether to take part in this research study.

Data Protection Privacy Notice

The General Data Protection Regulation [GDPR] and Goldsmiths Research: guidelines for participants

Please note that this document does not constitute, and should not be construed as, legal advice. These guidelines are designed to help participants understand their rights under GDPR which came into force on 25 May 2018.

Your rights as a participant (data subject) in this study

The updated data protection regulation is a series of conditions designed to protect an individual's personal data. Not all data collected for research is personal data.

Personal data is data such that a living individual can be identified; collection of personal data is sometimes essential in conducting research and GDPR sets out that data subjects should be treated in a lawful and fair manner and that information about the data processing should be explained clearly and transparently. Some data we might ask to collect falls under the heading of **special categories data**. This type of information includes data about an individual's race; ethnic origin; politics; religion; trade union membership; genetics; biometrics (where used for ID purposes); health; sex life; or sexual orientation. This data requires particular care.

Under GDPR you have the following rights over your personal data¹:

- **The right to be informed.** You must be informed if your personal data is being used.
- **The right of access.** You can ask for a copy of your data by making a 'subject access request'.
- **The right to rectification.** You can ask for your data held to be corrected.
- **The right to erasure.** You can ask for your data to be deleted.

¹ <https://ico.org.uk/your-data-matters/>

- **The right to restrict processing.** You can limit the way an organisation uses your personal data if you are concerned about the accuracy of the data or how it is being used.
- **The right to data portability.** You have the right to get your personal data from an organisation in a way that is accessible and machine-readable. You also have the right to ask an organisation to transfer your data to another organisation.
- **The right to object.** You have the right to object to the use of your personal data in some circumstances. You have an absolute right to object to an organisation using your data for direct marketing.
- **How your data is processed using automated decision making and profiling.** You have the right not to be subject to a decision that is based solely on automated processing if the decision affects your legal rights or other equally important matters; to understand the reasons behind decisions made about you by automated processing and the possible consequences of the decisions, and to object to profiling in certain situations, including for direct marketing purposes.

Please note that these rights are not absolute and only apply in certain circumstances. You should also be informed how long your data will be retained and who it might be shared with.

How does Goldsmiths treat my contribution to this study?

Your participation in this research is very valuable and any personal data you provide will be treated in confidence using the best technical means available to us. The university's legal basis for processing your data² as part of our research findings is a "task carried out in the public interest". This means that our research is designed to improve the health, happiness and well-being of society and to help us better understand the world we live in. It is not going to be used for marketing or commercial purposes.

In addition to our legal basis under Article 6 (as described above), for **special categories data** as defined under Article 9 of GDPR, our condition for processing is that it is "necessary for archiving purposes in the public interest, scientific or historical research purposes or statistical purposes".³

If your data contributes to data from a group then your ability to remove data may be limited as the study progresses, when removal of your data may cause damage to the dataset.

You should also know that you may contact any of the following people if you are unhappy about the way your data or your participation in this study are being treated:

- Goldsmiths Data Protection Officer – dp@gold.ac.uk (concerning your rights to control personal data).
- Chair, Goldsmiths Research Ethics and Integrity Sub-Committee - via reisc@gold.ac.uk, REISC Secretary (for any other element of the study).
- You also have the right to lodge a complaint with the Information Commissioner's Office at <https://ico.org.uk/make-a-complaint/>

This information has been provided by the Research Ethics and Integrity Sub-Committee with advice from the Research Services and Governance and Legal Teams.

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² GDPR Article 6; the six lawful bases for processing data are explained here: <https://ico.org.uk/for-organisations/guide-to-the-general-data-protection-regulation-gdpr/lawful-basis-for-processing/>

³ Article 9 of the GDPR requires this type of data to be treated with great care because of the more significant risks to a person's fundamental rights and freedoms that mishandling might cause, eg, by putting them at risk of unlawful discrimination.



Informed consent form

Informed Consent for Neural Style Transfer: Evaluating Content Preservation and Perceived Emotional Consistency Across Visually Distinct Artistic Styles

Please tick the appropriate boxes

Yes No

1. Taking part in the study

I have read and understood the study information dated 24/09/2026, or it has been read to me. I have been able to ask questions about the study and my questions have been answered to my satisfaction. ☐ Yes ☐ No

I consent voluntarily to be a participant in this study and understand that I can refuse to answer questions and I can withdraw from the study at any time, without having to give a reason. ☐ Yes ☐ No

I understand that if I do decide to withdraw, anonymised data can no longer be removed from the study after 24/09/2026. ☐ Yes ☐ No

2. Use of the information in the study

I understand that information I provide will be used for a final year project for BSc Computer Science University of London. ☐ Yes ☐ No

I understand that no personal information will be collected about me that can identify me, such as my name, email address, and that my response will be anonymous. ☐ Yes ☐ No

I agree that my information can be quoted in research outputs. ☐ Yes ☐ No

I am 18 years of age or older. ☐ Yes ☐ No

4. Signatures

Name of participant [IN CAPITALS]

Signature

Date

I have accurately read out the information sheet to the potential participant and, to the best of my ability, ensured that the participant understands to what they are freely consenting.

Name of researcher [IN CAPITALS]

Signature

Date